Despite our appeals for restraint, the Israelis on August 12 opened a new and even more brutal attack on civilian neighborhoods in Beirut that sickened me and many others in the White House. This provoked me into an angry demand for an end to the bloodletting. Here are excerpts from my diary:

> *Aug. 12*
>
> Met with the news the Israelis delivered the most devastating bomb and artillery attack Israel on West Beirut lasting 14 hours. Habib cabled—desperate—has basic agreement from all parties but can't arrange details of P.L.O. withdrawal because of the barrage.
>
> King Fahd [of Saudi Arabia] called begging me to do something. I told him I was calling P.M. Begin immediately. And I did. I was angry.
>
> I told him [Begin] it had to stop or our entire future relationship was endangered. I used the word "Holocaust" deliberately and said the symbol of his country was becoming "a picture of a seven month old baby with its arms blown off."
>
> He told me he had ordered the bombing stopped. I asked about the artillery fire. He claimed the P.L.O. had started that and Israeli forces had taken casualties. End of call. Twenty minutes later, he called to tell me he'd ordered an end to the barrage and pleaded for our continued friendship.

The phone calls worked, at least briefly bringing a cessation to the slaughter in Beirut. I had consciously used the word *holocaust* to describe the indiscriminate bombardment of Beirut because I knew it would have a special meaning for Begin.

After the phone calls, Israel reduced the intensity of its bombardment of Beirut—but its ground and air forces then began attacking populated areas in northern Lebanon,